Ritik Soni

Senior Backend Engineer – Python, FastAPI, Django, Kubernetes, LLM/SLM serving
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Summary

Senior Backend Engineer with 5+ years of experience building production Python services with FastAPI and Django REST Framework. Recent work: self-hosted LLM/SLM serving (vLLM), agentic AI chat backends, Neo4j graph pipelines, SSE streaming, Kubernetes on EKS, and Scrapy/XBRL crawling data platforms. Available from 20 Nov 2026.

Experience

PrivateCircle Sep 2022–Present
Senior Backend Engineer (Bengaluru, India) | Last working day: 20 November 2026

- Own the backend for Networks (networks.privatecircle.co, embedded in Research as RIN) and the Ask PrivateCircle agentic chat/deep-research API: FastAPI/DRF services (networks-api, user-auth-api, user-network-api, payments-api).
- Built "Ask English" natural-language company search: self-hosted vLLM serving a Qwen model on a GPU node, with prompt, column-catalog and validator design that turns a sentence into listing filters; shipped to production.
- Fixed SSE deep-research failures (PostgreSQL session held open for whole run behind pgBouncer) and RabbitMQ channel leak.
- Built the Day-0 ETL pipeline that loaded 10 billion+ Neo4j nodes from all data sources, using multiprocessing and multithreading (parallel CSV export, S3, LOAD CSV); a 10k-company run loaded ~434k nodes and relationships in 3m 44s.
- Set up AI agents (Grok Bot, Cursor, Claude) to monitor production infrastructure and automatically alert the tech team on Slack when something breaks.
- Run services on EKS with Helm/Helmfile and SOPS secrets; root-caused OOMKilled user-auth-api pods (a uvicorn worker per CPU vs 1Gi limit), capped workers, scaled replicas 1 to 4.
- Own the BSE/NSE crawling and XBRL data platform (Scrapy/Scrapyd, MongoDB, S3; 227 tests). Fixed the crawling pipeline, incl. a production share-price crawl failure from a unique-index clash (refresh then ran across 5,007 companies, 0 crashes).
- Ran a zero-error production storage cleanup reducing storage from 10 TB to 1 TB after deduplication. Built dry-run-first, hash-based dedup tooling (Infosys: PDFs 4,075 to 2,334, raw XBRL rows 3,386 to 12).
- Rolled out Networks to 199 additional customer packages in production (4 to 203); shipped fund and shareholder visibility controls (v1.4.0) backed by 166 automated tests.

Lechner Kunststoffteile Nov 2021–Sep 2022
Software Developer (Remote, Austria)

- Maintained and extended a Django-based ERP system, including custom Django Admin interfaces for internal teams.

EduGorilla TestSeries Sep 2021–Nov 2021
Software Engineering Intern (Lucknow, India)

- Developed backend APIs and internal tools in Django to support the test-series platform.

Freelance & Contract Work

Darukaa.earth – Software Developer, Freelance (Remote, Germany)

- Built an ESG reporting platform using FastAPI, React, and Google Cloud Platform for sustainability reporting workflows.
- Implemented LLM-based summarization pipelines to transform long-form ESG source documents into structured outputs.

Talio – Backend Developer, Freelance (Remote, Belgium)

- Built backend services for a hiring-platform MVP using Django REST Framework and OpenAI APIs.
- Developed API endpoints and supporting logic for candidate screening and workflow automation.

Projects

Company Inventory System – Python/FastAPI, Beanie/MongoDB, Playwright, Helm CronJobs

- Ingests financial filings of listed Indian companies from BSE, NSE and IR pages; ported from Node/TypeScript to Python in 2026, with a local-LLM fallback for IR-page discovery.

Neo4j + Kubernetes + FastAPI Template – github.com/ritiksoni00/fastapi_neo4j_k8s

- Production-ready template integrating Neo4j, Kubernetes, Docker, and FastAPI for graph-backed services.

Skills

Languages & Core: Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Django, DRF, Celery, Pydantic, SQLAlchemy, Beanie, SSE
LLM / SLM & Agentic AI: vLLM (Qwen) serving, agentic AI backends, prompt/validator design, Gemini (Vertex AI), LM Studio, OpenAI APIs
Kubernetes & Cloud: Kubernetes (EKS), Helm/Helmfile, Docker, SOPS/PGP, GitHub Actions, Nginx; AWS, Google Cloud, Linode
AI agents & dev tools: Grok Bot, Cursor, Claude
Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL, Neo4j, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, Redis, RabbitMQ, S3, Scrapy, Playwright, XBRL

Education

College of Technology and Engineering, Udaipur
B.Tech Computer Science 2018–2022